

```
echo '<!DOCTYPE html><html><title>2020 Jokebook</title></head><body>' > jokebook.htm
commonmark --unsafe --validate-utf8 jokebook.md >> jokebook.htm
echo '</body></html>' >> jokebook.htm
libreoffice --convert-to "html:HTML:EmbedImages" jokebook.htm
```

Here, the *.htm* file (referring to an external image) was created by CommonMark. LibreOffice consumed that *.htm* file and created a *.html* file with the text-encoded image. This self-contained HTML is now portable and not dependent on any external files. When you convert such an HTML document, the resultant ODT or DOCX file will also be self-contained and portable. Even if you delete the image file, you will still be able to see it in the *.html*, *.odt* or *.docx* files.

```
libreoffice --convert-to "html:HTML:EmbedImages" jokebook.htm
libreoffice --convert-to "odt" jokebook.html
libreoffice --convert-to "docx:MS Word 2007 XML" jokebook.odt
libreoffice --convert-to "pdf" jokebook.odt
```

Enhanced document content

As mentioned earlier, CommonMark outputs only a limited set of HTML tags. For creating content that it does not support, you will have to add raw HTML in your markdown.

Animal Jokes

* **Why did the lion cross the road?*

Because the buck stops here.

![[Lion and deer]](lion-and-deer.png)

Do not go overboard with this raw HTML content. LibreOffice has its own limited set of HTML tags and CSS styles that it can convert.

What does the screenshot in Figure 6 say? LibreOffice does not do rounded corners, among other things. So, temper your excitement.

This use of raw HTML is crude. It defeats the idea of markdown. The purpose of CommonMark is to create a well-structured document. Special styling can be affected by including CSS styles in the HTML template. I leave that as homework for you or your developers. (Just brush up on CSS pseudo-classes, selectors and attribute matching.) I gave the above example to make the concept easy to understand.

Unlike styles, tables are not fancy stuff. They are the nuts and bolts of financial documents. For those, you can use raw HTML inline. LibreOffice will convert HTML tables all right.

What about headers and footers? Does CommonMark support them? Can they be added to the HTML template similar to CSS



Figure 4: A text-encoded image is a huge chunk of unintelligible but plain text

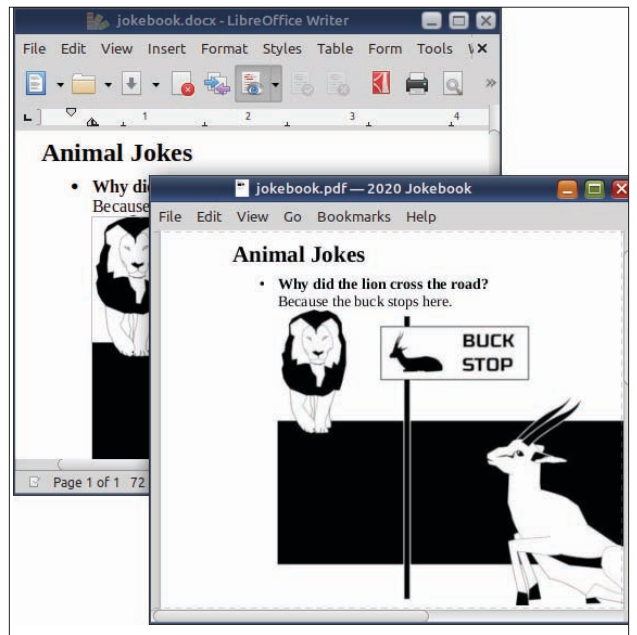


Figure 5: To make ODT and DOCX files self-contained or portable, images in the source HTML files should be text-encoded. PDF files use self-contained images, which makes them portable by definition



Figure 6: LibreOffice supports a limited set of HTML tags and CSS styles that it will convert to ODT, DOCX or PDF. For more sophisticated documents, use wkhtmltopdf